

DEVELOPERS

Written by

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Theme Song: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KMU0tzLwhbE>

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INT. UCLA - COMPUTER SCIENCE BUILDING - CLASSROOM A

One long rectangular strip of white board replaces what would be the chalkboard on every wall of this college classroom. Students ages 21-65 occupy the room, buzzing with both delight and fear.

WELCOME TO CODING BOOTCAMP is lazily written on the white board behind the podium. Three teachers assistant's stoically line up behind AKRAM SINGH (mid-30s, a down-to-earth hard-ass) who begins to survey the class before calling out...

AKRAM

Hello! Happy Monday.

Akram gets three muffled "Hello"'s in return. He brashly taps the microphone on the podium. The class winces.

AKRAM (CONT'D)

Okay, cool. Just wanted to make sure before I took that personally. Welcome to the first day of UCLA Extension's Coding Bootcamp. My name is Akram and I'll be your teacher for the next 12 weeks. This class will meet three times a week and every week there will be a new assignment you'll be graded on. Don't miss a day unless you're dead and don't fucking fail.

Nervous laughs. *Haha?*

AKRAM (CONT'D)

There will also be three big group projects which you will want to do well on so they go into your portfolio. Software engineers have portfolios. And you signed up for this class to what?

MUFFLED ANSWERS

Be a software engineer.

AKRAM

That's right. And if your portfolios suck, you'll only be showing potential employers you wasted \$15k attending this bootcamp.

(MORE)

AKRAM (CONT'D)

We do these projects in groups because in most corporate tech environments, you will be contributing to a team so it's actually a good thing we do that quick in here. We also try to emphasize the importance of becoming friends quick.

(BEAT)

Who here already has a job at a tech company?

Out of 30 or so people, 10 raise their hands.

AKRAM (CONT'D)

Be friends with these people.

The 10 slowly lower their hands.

AKRAM (CONT'D)

No, seriously. Suck up.

(BEAT)

If you just have one degree, this is probably the hardest thing you'll ever do academically. But I want you to rest assured, we've been there.

The TA's behind Akram nod.

AKRAM (CONT'D)

I know you. I was you. Your immigrant parents told you that you could be *anything* you wanted to be and when you said the thing you wanted, they said "except that". So now you're trying to turn your whole life around to show you don't take their hard work and sacrifices for granted.

Spotlight on a pained LARRY (30, immature and sarcastic - think Filipino Robert Sheehan)

LARRY

(SOTTO) Ow.

AKRAM

Or maybe you've chosen a thing and you hate it. Maybe it's ruining your life and you want to pivot! You want to make or build something that people actually believe in.

Spotlight on JAZZY (25, frenetically focused, plus-sized girlboss) with hearts in her eyes, truly inspired.

AKRAM (CONT'D)

Or maybe your company is giving you a tech stipend to be here - and you're looking to level up because you need money if you're going to take care of your little orphaned brothers.

Spotlight on: YOONA (28, Korean Aubrey Plaza) putting the pieces together and suddenly very suspicious...

YOONA

Now wait--

AKRAM

I don't know, I don't know! What I do know is that most of you are in the right place with the wrong expectations. This is a rigorous training program. Half of you will be gone by end of the week.

Terrified looks from students.

AKRAM (CONT'D)

The other half of you **will** change your lives.

The class is all smiles.

AKRAM (CONT'D)

You can take the next 12 weeks and learn how to code or you can sit around oscillating between sucking up and suicide.

An OLDER WOMAN literally clutches her pearls. The class is enthralled with Akram.

AKRAM (CONT'D)

I repeat, the next 12 weeks **will** change your life for the better - **if** you let it. Coding is hard work but this is a rigorous training program for that reason. Your success in this class depends entirely on you.

(BEAT)

Behind me are your class TA's.

The TA's wave/nod.

AKRAM (CONT'D)

They'll be helping me out for the duration of the class to grade assignments and walk you thr-

The doors FLING open. Enter NIRVAAN (27, Indian, Handsome, big Andy Dwyer from *Parks and Rec* energy). He is in full costume and makeup from *The King and I*. No one flinches.

AKRAM (CONT'D)

(SHOOK)

Does anyone else see him?

NIRVAAN

I'm so sorry. Rehearsal ran late!

Nirvaan holds up his laptop and his notebook.

NIRVAAN (CONT'D)

I'm ready to learn!

Nirvaan's laptop falls on the floor. Yoona lets out a small scream. The class is in shock. Nirvaan picks it up. Opens it.

NIRVAAN (CONT'D)

It's okay. Not even a crack.

Oh boy.

Nirvaan stands in the middle of the class, panting.

NIRVAAN (CONT'D)

Oh no, you already started.

AKRAM

(SARCASTIC)

My bad! Wasn't sure you were coming.

Nirvaan kicks the air.

AKRAM (CONT'D)

Please sit down. That reminds me - do not add me on social media. You aren't that interesting on TikTok, I don't need new friends on Facebook and no, I will not give you kudos on LinkedIn. (MIMICKING) *"Who the hell uses LinkedIn?"* Everyone. Everyone in the industry uses LinkedIn, get one if you want a real job.

The class is rattled.

AKRAM (CONT'D)

Which brings me to my next point...
If you don't have what it takes to
be an engineer - you can still get
your refund if you leave now.

Around eleven students stand and hurriedly leave the class.

INT. UCLA - COMPUTER SCIENCE BUILDING - CLASSROOM A - LATER

9:28 PM. Everyone in the classroom is taking notes, planning their exit, or... well, a few older professionals are nodding off at their desk.

AKRAM

You guys are cohort A, meeting on Monday's and Wednesday's and will meet up with cohort B for our Saturday sessions. At the end of the course, every team in both cohorts will present their final project to a panel of MAANG industry guests. That's Meta, Apple, Amazon, Netflix and Google. Many lucky teams have gone on to work at a MAANG company and the rest send out around 603 resumes before they secure their first full-time position.

The class looks scared again. Akram looks at his Apple watch.

AKRAM (CONT'D)

Okay. That's enough. First assignment's due Saturday. One of our Teacher's Assistants will email you your project groups momentarily.

We turn around to the back of the class to see the TA's: PEDRO (27, Latinx, intimidating), ADAM (30, White, judge-y but quiet) and FAYE (36, Russian, tall as hell) wave.

AKRAM (CONT'D)

Like I said, with so many people leaving this week, feel free to redistribute yourselves as needed. This project will be a breeze if you work together and if you did the pre-work this summer.

YOONA, JAZZY, LARRY

Pre-work?!?!?

AKRAM

Okay. Bye.

Akram bolts out of the room. With the click of Faye's mouse, little email noises start going off in the classroom. Yoona checks her email.

LIKE THREE PEOPLE

GROUP FOUR? Group two?! Over here!

RANDO #1

GROUP ONE?

Yoona reads her email and looks around. Everyone seems to be finding each other. She gets up and goes over to Larry. Once behind him, she can see he is googling "Am I going to fail because I didn't do the pre-work?".

Larry turns around, closing his laptop.

LARRY

No good answers btdubs.

YOONA

Are you in group five?

LARRY

No. Three.

Yoona excuses herself to find her group. Larry does the same. He goes over to Nirvaan in his group.

LARRY (CONT'D)

Group three? King and ME?

Larry holds his hand up for a fist bump. Nirvaan bumps it.

NIRVAAN

No. Group 8, my guy. Sorry!

Larry nods and walks away.

Over with a mildly panicked Jazzy, her group is getting acquainted.

GUY IN JAZZY'S GROUP

Yeah, I spent like 40 hours going over data structures, boolean algebra and operators. I think I'm getting the hang of it.

Her group members are buzzing about the pre-work.

JAZZY
I didn't know we had homework.

GIRL IN JAZZY'S GROUP
How didn't you know that?

JAZZY
I just didn't, I guess. But I'll
get all caught up by the time we
meet. I'll pull an all-nighter!
(BEAT)
Do you guys wanna meet tomorrow
night? I can ask my roommate if-

GIRL IN JAZZY'S GROUP
Where do you live?

JAZZY
Koreatown.

Everyone has a visceral reaction to that.

Yoona appears behind Jazzy.

YOONA
Group five?

JAZZY
No, sorry.

They smile at each other as Yoona walks off. She puts on
headphones and heads out of the classroom.

EXT. YOONA'S APARTMENT - NIGHT

Yoona is on the phone with her boss, BOSSLADY (30s, doing
wayyyy too much, opposite of mindful).

INT. MEDIOCRE APARTMENT WITH FANCY ELECTRONICS

Bosslady walks on a walking pad while checking her apple
watch and securing her airpods in her ear. We see a side by
side of their convo on screen.

BOSS
Can you still hear me?

YOONA
Yes.

BOSSLADY (V.O.)

Couldn't hear ya there. Anyway, what was I saying. I'm uhhh... looking at these alts for the poop emoji's and I don't think they have enough hats. A beanie isn't enough anymore to peddle a poop tea to guys. Are there more hat options you can think of? Like have you ever been to crazy hat day at high school?

YOONA

No.

BOSSLADY (V.O.)

Okay, well think funny like... a bald cap, or a yarmulke or I wore a hijab once. Inclusive and hysterical!

YOONA

Yeah. Very funny.

BOSSLADY (V.O.)

Oh good, you get it. Can you doodle up 10 more options before end of day?

YOONA

End of day? It's 10 pm. Can it wait till tomorrow? I have to put the boys to bed and I just started coding bootcamp. I kind of wanted to-

BOSSLADY

LOVE that you're using the tech stipend. It's not covering the whole thing right?

YOONA

No.

BOSSLADY

Oh good. I mean! Listen... the next few weeks are crucial for us. You have to remember to put this company above all else!

YOONA

I'm trying to get better about setting boundaries. My work hours are not suggestions.

BOSSLADY

Of course not! Listen! I know
you're having a hard time but the
light is at the end of the tunnel.
Stacey said she sees the late hours
you've been putting in and wants
you to get your h1n1 visa.

YOONA

The vaccine?

BOSSLADY

I don't know the specifics of your
arrangements but I know you're
getting paid under the table and I
know our company could sponsor you.

Yoona is torn up about this. She's heard this before.

BOSSLADY (CONT'D)

Put the boys to bed, be a girl in
stem and send the alts at 1 am!
Stacey is in England so it'll be
like 9 in the morning there.

YOONA

Okay. Bye.

She hangs up and sighs. She unlocks the door to her apartment
and inside we see:

MIN-JUN, DAL, and EUGENE (5, precocious triplets, Yoona's
younger brothers) are pouring liquid cheese into a pot,
dumping uncooked rice noodles in the concoction and using
their hands to mix it all up on the coffee table. Yoona
gasps.

EUGENE

BIG SISTER!

DAL

OH NO!

INT. YOONA'S APARTMENT - 5 MINUTES LATER

SUNGJUN (30's, Yoona's older brother) is wearing scrubs and
still scolding the triplets in Korean. Inconvenienced, the
triplets take their pots and ingredients back to the kitchen.
Yoona sips on a cup of barley tea water she poured.

SUNGJUN

And where have you BEEN, Yoona?
I'm late to the hospital!
(MORE)

SUNGJUN (CONT'D)

Did you make the appointment for Mr. Polachek to come check out the mold in the bathroom?

YOONA

No, but look what I taught them to do when he does.

(IN KOREAN)

Landlord's here!

Perfectly in sync, the triplets start coughing from the kitchen. Truly, a great performance. Sungjun stifles a laugh and shakes his head.

SUNGJUN

Where have you been?

YOONA

I started coding bootcamp. Day 1 of trying to leave XX. You know she just called me?

SUNGJUN

Just now?!

YOONA

Yes. And I have to turn in more work by 1 am tonight and probably every night this week because xx. And I have pre-work I didn't know about so I am already behind.

SUNGJUN

You're starting school again! You're gonna be behind in everything for awhile. You'll get it done. Congratulations, by the way! And sorry...

Sungjun ushers towards the kids.

YOONA

Yeah, yeah... why aren't they in bed? I have to-

MIN-JUN

(CALLING OUT FROM THE KITCHEN)
Sungjun is bad reader! We wait for big sister to read us the news!

SUNGJUN

I tried to read them The Washington Post but I kept hitting paywalls.

Sungjun disappears into the boys bedroom to collect his belongings for work. Sungjun's phone starts to ring.

DAL
Is that mommy?

YOONA
Dal, you know we've talked about this. Mommy isn't coming back.

DAL
(SAD)
That's right.
(BRITISH ACCENT)
She is with PEPPA PIG'S FAMILY!!

Eugene jumps on top of his other brothers and they all wrestle each other, shrieking in adorable British yodels. Yoona shakes her head at them and Sungjun answers his phone as he exits the house waving goodbye.

YOONA
Bye bro.

Yoona looks over at her brothers.

YOONA (CONT'D)
Go into your room! I'll come and read you The Atlantic in a minute.

EUGENE
Which one?

YOONA
(ROLLING HER EYES)
The Surprising Benefits of Talking to Strangers.

The boys excitedly run to their room like it's Christmas morning. Yoona walks over to the kitchen, and puts her cup away. On the fridge, she eyes finger-painted drawings of her family that her little brother's made. Sungjun, Yoona, Mommy and the three of them as weird celestial turkeys.

At the top of the fridge, there's a picture of their MOM on a Korean funeral program surrounded by clouds. Before Yoona let's herself feel it -

DAL
GET HIM!

Yoona peeks into her brothers' bedroom. Min-jun's hands are in Eugene's mouth trying to pull apart his jaw. Yoona sighs.

INT. JAZZY'S APARTMENT - MORNING

A haggard Jazzy exits her bedroom into the living room. Rocks from (probably) a Target parking lot surround a portable teal cot. A laptop sits atop a cabinet playing something annoying. Jazzy gets close and we see it reads:

10 HOUR - EXTREMELY POWERFUL (639 Hz) HEART CHAKRA FREQUENCY

HANNAN (O.C.)

Jasmine?

Jazzy jumps. She turns around to see her roommate HANNAN (35, overly-tanned, stressed out hippie) who has turned their living room into her de facto reiki studio.

JAZZY

Hannah. *Oh my God*, you scared me.

HANNAN

You look horrible.

JAZZY

Are you... is that my concealer?

HANNAN

No, it's my new bronzer. Please don't give me shit. You have no idea how hard it is to get my business to the top of Yelp without being a bipoc.

JAZZY

By.. product?

HANNAN

A bisexual indie person of color. Like Jason Momoa.

JAZZY

Oh. Bipoc. That's actually a bisexual indigenous or person of... actually... that is confusing I don't know who that term is for.

HANNAN

You get me?

Hannan starts organizing the living room. This is her heaven.

JAZZY

Hey, so I look awful because we got assigned to a group for our first project last night and I didn't do the like... summer homework?

HANNAN

Yes! You're coding now! Warrior queen! I'm so proud. Let me know if I can do anything at all to help!

JAZZY

Thanks. Actually - I need the living room tonight.

HANNAN

Oh, I can't do that. Back to back clients till 10.

JAZZY

But... I never ask for the living room. Can you take your client to your bedroom? I can move the cot to-

HANNAN

Ah, I wish I could Jazz but most of my clients are workaholics and you and your coding friends and your over-productive Silicon Valley vibes are just... not going to be a good pairing.

Jazzy sulks.

INT. UCLA - COMPUTER SCIENCE BUILDING - NIGHT

Wednesday evening. Noticeably like ten less people. Yoona scrolls, reading documentation on CSS.

She gets a text message from someone labeled HELL with an emoji briefcase that reads:

MY FAVORITE JUNIOR GRAPHIC DESIGNER DELIVERED! Great job! Stacey wants a revision on the approved on landing page graphics...

Yoona tenses up.

She types back "By when?" and almost simultanenously she gets "EOD".

Yoona inhales sharply. She looks at the kid in back of her.

YOONA

Hey. Are you group five?

RANDO #1

No. We're group one. You still haven't found your group?

YOONA

No. I emailed them. No answer.

RANDO #1

I think they all dropped out. I heard a TA say like 14 students dropped so far.

YOONA

Really? Ok... Guess I am on my own.

Yoona turns back around.

In the corner of the classroom, Larry is standing in a circle with his group.

LARRY

What did you say this was called?

OLDER DUDE

A standup meeting.

LARRY

Love it.

(TO THE GROUP)

Alright party people, when do you wanna meet? I'm itchin' to get started. Not in a way that I would need medical assistance. I have my shots! Just got ants in my pants. Haha. Just kidding... just antsy!

The girls in his group roll their eyes and walk away.

LARRY (CONT'D)

What the hell?

OLDER DUDE

If I understood women, my man, I wouldn't be going through my third divorce. Anyway, I've got to go to work. I just wanted to touch base.

LARRY

What? You're gonna miss class?!

OLDER DUDE
Yeah, I got a graveyard shift.

LARRY
Oh, sweet. Where?

OLDER DUDE
A cemetery.

The older dude takes his beat up old briefcase and walks out of class. Larry is confused.

LARRY
Guess I'm on my own...

Dejected, he makes his way back to his seat, passing Jazzy who walks over to her group.

JAZZY
SO sorry about yesterday guys. I know I offered my place up and had to retract last minute.

Jazzy's groupmates - SKINNY BLAND MAN (20s, White), GUY WITH COMBOVER (40s, Japanese) stare away. PRISSY GIRL (20s, Indian) pipes up.

PRISSY GIRL
That was really unprofessional but we were relieved. We didn't want to go to Koreatown. Anyway, we coded out most of the project last night on Zoom. Why didn't you show up?

JAZZY
I-I didn't get a link?

GUY WITH COMBOVER
I sent it.

Jazzy scrolls her email on her laptop looking for it.

PRISSY GIRL
We'll let it slide but we're giving the last leg of the project over to you since we scaffolded it.

JAZZY
Scaffold.. ed?

SKINNY BLAND MAN
Oh god. Another person who wants their hand held.

JAZZY

Excu-

PRISSY GIRL

Can we count on you to finish it?
Or are you minutes from dropping
this program too?

JAZZY

I paid for this class with my
savings - I am not dropping. I'll
finish whatever you guys send.
Scouts honor!

The group hesitantly nods. Akram walks in like a hurricane.

AKRAM

Alright dweebs, take a seat.

Everyone starts shuffling back to their seats.

INT. UCLA - COMPUTER SCIENCE BUILDING - LATER

A scary montage of Akram live coding things that look really complicated plays out. Nirvaan takes notes, Yoona attempts to take notes but keeps glancing back and forth at her phone, Jazzy and Larry scratch their heads.

AKRAM

Floating divs are tough but you'll
get the hang of it. Any questions?

Some people shift in their seats. Most have a question but are too scared to ask. Until one brave soldier...

LARRY

What - what is uhm... going on?

AKRAM

Sorry?

LARRY

Yeah. My bad. What's a div?

JAZZY

(SOTTO) Thank God.

Akram looks at his watch.

AKRAM

Alright, that's time.

Jazzy, Larry, and Yoona huff as the class slowly begins to pack up and chat with their group members.

Everyone begins slowly shuffling out.

Jazzy overhears Nirvaan's with his group.

NIRVAAN

Zoom honestly works better for me.
I have rehearsals for *The King and I* and a showcase I'm getting ready for. And my 9-5. So, I can do like...

(LOOKS AT PHONE)

Friday morning... like 5 am?

His group nods along like sheep, in awe of him.

NIRVAAN (CONT'D)

Heck yeah. Up top!

They all high-five him. Larry shakes his head. Nirvaan sees Jazzy packing up. He heads over and plops his laptop in front of her.

NIRVAAN (CONT'D)

He didn't really do a good job at explaining divs huh?

JAZZY AND LARRY

No.

Nirvaan takes in his audience. Yoona slows down to listen.

NIRVAAN

I'll show you guys some div stuff.

Nirvaan opens his laptop and Pedro (the scary TA) swoops in and closes it.

PEDRO

Go home. If they have a question they have to schedule time to talk to one of us. Don't help other students - especially in the beginning when you probably don't know what you're talking about either.

Pedro walks away.

YOONA

Why is everyone making this harder for us?

JAZZY

It's giving bootcamp bootcamp.

LARRY

And ladies do not belong in war.
Believe me.

JAZZY

Didn't your group kick you out for
being a Kanye apologist?

LARRY

What? No!

NIRVAAN

That's the rumour. Anyway, do you
wanna go to Starbucks or something?
I can show you guys there.

JAZZY

He literally just said-

NIRVAAN

Listen - I might not know
everything he's right. But I know
HTML and CSS. I have a bachelors in
computer science. I wasn't really
paying attention though, it was
online. I got it mostly to appease
my parents.

(SOTTO)

Between you and me, they think I'm
in residency at UCLA.

YOONA

How did you-

NIRVAAN

Oh! I also have a bachelors in
biology.

Nirvaan smiles, adjusts his posture to take in the
compliments.

YOONA

What a waste.

JAZZY

Yeah, everything you just said made
me feel violent.

NIRVAAN

Is that bad? I'm also getting my
master's here. In acting.

Yoona and Jazzy roll their eyes, sick to their stomachs.

JAZZY

I have to go.

Yoona and Jazzy leave.

Nirvaan is actually hurt. He looks at Larry. Larry shrugs.

LARRY

I don't know man. I don't understand women. How do you do it all? I thought I wasted all my money writing the unauthorized version of Kanye West's biography... but you have like three degrees you're not using! What would your asian parents say if they knew?

Nirvaan's phone rings - he puts out his hand to shush Larry.

NIRVAAN

Mom, hey. I can't talk right now.
Yeah. We lost a guy today.

One tear falls down his face. Larry watches in awe of Nirvaan's killer fucking performance. Nirvaan hangs up.

NIRVAAN (CONT'D)

Nailed it.

LARRY

(IMPRESSED)

Wow.

INT. KTOWN CAFE - DAY

It's Friday. Jazzy is putting together everything on her laptop. We see the page scroll. All her group mate's pictures and their info is appearing correctly. She's proud of herself. She looks around the cafe and gets up to order another drink.

One person ahead of her. And when it's Jazzy's turn-

JAZZY

Hey! Hi.

BARISTA

Hello.

Behind this entire conversation is a tall LANKY DUDE who walks in, sees Jazzy's computer - and bounces with it.

JAZZY

Can I have a maxi matcha
marshmallow milk tea? Blended?

Jazzy takes out her card to swipe.

BARISTA

\$8.50. Cash only.

JAZZY

Cash only? I paid with my card an
hour ago?

BARISTA

We're cash only after 5.

Jazzy squints. *Okay...* She turns around and heads to her table only to find her laptop missing. She circles the small table. And then again, only counterclockwise.

JAZZY

Sorry, did you see someone take my
laptop?

GIRL PRETENDING TO DO WORK IN CAFE

Yeah.

JAZZY

Why... why did you-

GIRL PRETENDING TO DO WORK IN CAFE

You didn't ask me to watch it.
Thought it was your friend or
something.

(BEAT)

He was tall?

JAZZY

I... I just finished everything.

Jazzy tears up.

EXT. KTOWN CAFE - DAY

Jazzy looks at the uber app on her phone as her driver appears. It's Larry!

Jazzy looks down at the app.

JAZZY
You are not Maria?

LARRY
That's my mom. I am actually banned
for 17 days for taking someone to
the airport at the same time I was
going to the airport. Too much
luggage in the back... they
complained.
(BEAT)
Did you really call an Uber to
drive you three blocks?

Jazzy closes her eyes and sighs heavily.

INT. YOONA'S APARTMENT - DAY

The living room is padded with a tarp. Yoona is wearing a raincoat with a protective veil covering her laptop as her brothers chase each other around the living room with water spray bottles.

EUGENE
What's that?

He points at the screen with his spray bottle. We see Yoona has drawn the words "MILK IS BACK" and under them, a lumberjack cuddling with cow tits.

YOONA
Close your eyes, please.

And Eugene listens. Sungjun enters the living room.

SUNGJUN
Yoona, I actually can't take them
tomorrow. Someone just quit, so I
have to go in.

YOONA
What? No. Tell them you have no
childcare plans, tell them I died -
tell them anything!

SUNGJUN
And lose my job?

YOONA
You want me to fail this class? I
can't miss it! Take the day off.
They can't fire you!

SUNGJUN

Yes, they can! And you know how hard it was for me to find a hospital that would hire an undocumented nurse.

Yoona knows he's right. She's annoyed.

YOONA

This is what happens when you die and are an only child! Ughh. This isn't fair!

Yoona puts her hand to her head. Eugene starts to rub Yoona's temples. Sungjun feels bad.

INT. LARRY'S PRIUS - DAY

Jazzy has just unloaded onto Larry the last hour of her life.

LARRY

Whoa. So they up-charged you on the matcha latte?

JAZZY

(INCREDULOUS)

That's all you got from my-

LARRY

I just mean - they sound like they were in on it!

Larry pulls up to her apartment and puts his hazards on.

LARRY (CONT'D)

Why are you going home? You should be going to the police department!

JAZZY

I don't have time to spend a day at the police department. There's nothing that they can do that's going to get me an A. My group already hates me.

Jazzy sulks down in her seat. Larry gets a call and puts up 1 finger to Jazzy. He answers it.

LARRY

Hey. Can I call you back later? I am-

LARRY'S DAD

Larry. This is your dad.

His voice booms through the speakers. Scaring Jazzy, she jumps, hitting her head on the top of his prius.

LARRY

Hi Dad. Yeah I know. Can I call you back in like 30 minutes?

LARRY'S DAD

Your mother and I were just talking. We're not happy. I think you're wasting your time with the computer wizkid stuff. You're not good with that stuff. You always break the input on the television and can't get your mom back to Netflix.

LARRY

Well. No, I switch it to DVD and you guys *think* I broke it.

Larry's mom takes the phone.

LARRY'S MOM

Hi Larry. Sweetie. I'm sorry. We are just worried. It is very hard to make it in the movie industry. Especially when you won't write to Olivia Rodrigo.

LARRY

Mom, that would be so creepy at this time and also it never works like that.

LARRY'S DAD

Did he say he can't write her because he's dyslexic?

LARRY'S MOM

We just don't want you to fail at something else, again.

LARRY

Thanks for your support, mom.

LARRY'S MOM

Larry. You are my son and I love you. I promise, if you want to burn your life down - we will still be here for you.

JAZZY

Oh my God!?

LARRY'S DAD

LARRY?!

LARRY'S MOM

IS THAT A GIRLFRIEND?

LARRY

No! I've gotta go. Bye!!

(BEAT)

Anyway... you said your group hates
you. Well -

JAZZY

Your parents hate you more.

LARRY

What? No! They're just blunt.
English isn't their first language.
Anyway - do you wanna join my
group?

JAZZY

Oh my God, really?

LARRY

Yeah!

JAZZY

Yes. I am going to be totally
kicked out of mine. Who is in
yours?

LARRY

You're looking at em'.

(OFF JAZZY)

At least I have a laptop!

Jazzy smiles.

INT. UCLA - COMPUTER SCIENCE BUILDING - CLASSROOM B

It's presentation day and due to this class being combined
with cohort B, there are about 20 more people than we are
used to seeing.At the back of the room is a panel of four seats for Faye,
Adam, Pedro and Akram; who are going over details of the day.Every member of Nirvaan's group takes center stage wearing
oversized light blue jeans and black turtlenecks. They look
like Steve Jobs on an episode of *Blue's Clues*. They all stand
up there, glistening with their 120 watt smiles. We almost
don't even realize not one of them has a computer.

AKRAM

Okay, Cohort A's group 1 up
first...

(READING)

Hackstreet boys?

In unison, they do the 'bye-bye-bye' move.

NIRVAAN

You're welcome.

Nirvaan takes a step forward.

NIRVAAN (CONT'D)

If a tree falls in a forest and no
one's around... does it make a
sound? I don't know the answer to
that but it's kind of like when
someone pays you on Venmo and it
goes into your "Venmo" account.
What even is that? I never signed
up for a Venmo account. Did you? Is
that real?

HORNY GIRL

He's so right.

Jazzy looks at her incredulously.

NIRVAAN

I don't know about you but I'm a
millennial trying to adapt to a
world I was not adequately prepared
for. Like a plumber learning their
craft only to get in the field and
realize we're not unclogging shower
drains but fighting fires! Maybe
fighting fires isn't what we signed
up for but we can either talk about
how unfair that is or suit the heck
up and save some lives. To be or
not to be, it's up to you now.

Dead silence.

NIRVAAN (CONT'D)

You can clap.

AKRAM

What?

NIRVAAN

What?

HACKSTREET BOYS
(BARKING)

Akram stares in disbelief.

OLDER BLACK WOMAN
(HOWLS)

AKRAM
Stop that! STOP IT RIGHT NOW!

The class falls silent.

AKRAM (CONT'D)
What was that?

NIRVAAN
What is what?

PEDRO
Dude, what is your project?

NIRVAAN
Oh! We pseudo-coded the idea.

A kid from his group connects his tablet to the HDMI cable on the podium and it brings up his NOTES app. He scrolls through some text and we read:

"Here lies code that will function for the login", "Insert code to handle rejections", "Here goes code for the future".

AKRAM
I've seen enough.

NIRVAAN
You're welcome.

Everyone behind Nirvaan raises their fist and starts to pump them like it's the Microsoft crew introducing Windows 95'. The whole class howls and claps.

AKRAM
Please sit down. Now!
Stop clapping!!

CUT TO:

LATER

Larry and Jazzy crawl up to the podium.

AKRAM
You two aren't in the same group?

LARRY
We made our own.

AKRAM
When?

JAZZY
Everyone in his group hates him.
His parents too.

AKRAM
Ouch?

LARRY
No, it's true.

JAZZY
My group kicked me out. They want
me dead. And stole my laptop.

Jazzy's group guffaws.

JAZZY (CONT'D)
We've been up for over 24 hours
trying to join our projects
together. Please can we just
present?

AKRAM
Okay. Go ahead.

LARRY
Okay! So this is our site. As you
can see the menu bar is...

Jazzy presses the dropdown menu button literally labeled
dropdown. Up comes three options on the menu labeled
literally "Action" "Another action" "Something else here".

LARRY (CONT'D)
Ha. Okay. Moving down the page, you
can see our pictures.

Jazzy clicks on her picture - up pops up an ugly pop-up modal
on the left side of the screen containing her bio.

JAZZY
I know. It's not pretty.

PEDRO
Whoa... what library did you use?

JAZZY

(HOSTILE)

I didn't go to a library I did this
at a cafe. Which I regret, **okay?**

The TA's share a glance.

FAYE

He means coding library. What
coding library did you use?

Everyone stares. Larry looks at Jazzy. She didn't hear the
question because she is stuck in time fighting off sleep.

ADAM

(LOUDLY)

What happens when you enter an
email and press submit?

JAZZY

It sends our group gmail an email.

AKRAM

Whoa... really? That wasn't a part
of the assignment.

JAZZY

It felt wrong without it.

AKRAM

You took time to learn how to set
up a send request for email?

JAZZY

(WHINEY)

I think I did a good thing but
you're making it sound like a bad
thing and I can't tell why
everyone's so mad at me. I'm sorry
I live in Koreatown!

Akram and the TA's look at each other.

LARRY

Hey, paparazzi please! Enough
questions for the day for the
Jazzster. She's-

ADAM

So what did you do?

LARRY
 Nothing as cool as she did. Tbh.
 (BEAT)
 Oh, I did this!

Larry scrolls down to a button. He presses it and "Tell Me When To Go" by E-40 featuring Keak da Sneak starts to play. Jazzy gasps.

LARRY (CONT'D)
 Come on. What are you? From New York?

Larry looks out. He sees the crowd is dead and decides to start smeezing. Jazzy watches in horror.

JAZZY
 Are you joking?!

LARRY
 Is Biggie your favorite rapper?

GEN-Z GIRL #1
 Not cool, dude! She is clearly uncomfortable by you appropriating her culture.

Jazzy sharply turns her head to glare at her.

GEN-Z GIRL #2
 It's okay. We got you, queen.
 (TO LARRY)
 You! Stop dancing!

LARRY
 I am smeezing? Not crip walking?

Jazzy is offended.

GEN-Z GIRL #2
 She coded the whole thing! She learned a library and you're taking credit for it! Just like a selfish American!

LARRY
 I am filipino!!!

AKRAM
 STOP!!!! Stop dancing. Stop talking. Stop moving.
 (TO JAZZY)
 (MORE)

AKRAM (CONT'D)

Holding space for you to say
anything because if I don't I'll
feel bad.

JAZZY

I hate you all.

ALL GEN-Z GIRLS

Valid.

AND LASTLY...

AKRAM

Cohort A's group Five?

Yoonas gets up to present. We see on her computer her three
younger brothers running a god-damn muck on Zoom. Dal rattles
the TV in the living room and Yoonas rips out an AirPods and
screams into it.

YOONA

(HARSHLY IN KOREAN)

Sit down! All of you! ***Sit down
right now!***

Four traumatized Korean students obey her immediately.

YOONA (CONT'D)

Haha! Sorry. It's joke.

AKRAM

This class loves their bits, don't
they?

The TA's nod. Yoonas hides the Zoom and her brothers gather
around their iPad screen to watch her. She plugs in her
laptop and the view is connected to the white board behind
her. Yoonas's website is very beautiful.

AKRAM (CONT'D)

Whoa.

YOONA

So my page is my fake groups page.

AKRAM

Why do you have a fake group?

YOONA

I couldn't find my real one.

On the site, three avatars appear of her little brothers.

AKRAM

Is it just me or are these K-Pop groups getting younger?

YOONA

These are my three little brothers.

NIRVAAN

Are they triplets?

YOONA

Yeah.

GEN-Z GIRL #2

So cute!

PEDRO

Can you click on the second icon?

YOONA

No.

(BEAT)

But I coded out all the sections, as you can see-

ADAM

Can you click on the menu bar?

YOONA

Also, no.

PEDRO

So, functionally speaking... what works on your site?

YOONA

Nothing.

Akram, Pedro, Adam and Faye look at each other.

FAYE

Did you develop this locally?

YOONA

Kind of. I live in Downey.

All the smart smarties snicker.

AKRAM

No, locally like on your computer. You didn't host this site anywhere?

YOONA

I don't even know what that means.

AKRAM

Well, this is really pretty but nothing works.

YOONA

Well, I will learn and it will work.

You kind of believe her spunk! Annoyed, Yoona exes out of her project. The classes eye's widen. Then-

ADAM

Sorry, did you code a gif?

FAYE

Oh my God.

Yoona's eyes widen.

YOONA

No no no!

And Min-Jun jumps from the table, heading straight for the necks of both of his brothers and screams:

MIN-JUN

JUDO CHOP!

The entire class braces just as Min-Jun opts for a belly flop instead. His brothers choke out air and start giggling. Yoona is calmed. She looks up at the flabbergasted class.

CUT TO:

INT. UCLA - COMPUTER SCIENCE BUILDING - HALLWAY

Akram stares in disbelief at Larry, Yoona, Nirvaan and Jazzy.

AKRAM

I've run eight bootcamps in the last four years. Never have I ever seen project groups fuck up the first assignment *this* bad.

LARRY

I can explain. I don't really think-

AKRAM

Stop talking. Every time you talk, I want to go to HR.

Nirvaan laughs.

AKRAM (CONT'D)

Jesus. I'm still trying to get my mind un-fucked from that ridiculous monologue you recited.

NIRVAAN

I beg your pardon - that was *entirely* improvised.

Akram stifles his anger and looks at Yoona and Jazzy.

AKRAM

(TO LARRY AND JAZZY)

Who did the look and feel of the site?

LARRY

Jazzy did. She deleted my code. I just copied and-

AKRAM

Probably for the best.

(TO JAZZY)

Jazzy, you made the site work. You surpassed the project requirements on functionality. But your site was butt ass ugly.

(TO YOONA)

Yoona, you made a beautiful site. Seriously impressive. But nothing worked. Useless.

(BEAT)

Did you two like sync up in the bathroom or something?

Larry howls with laughter.

AKRAM (CONT'D)

If he laughs I know that was-

NIRVAAN

Offensive. Seriously inappropriate.

Jazzy and Yoona are kind of into Nirvaan defending them.

NIRVAAN (CONT'D)

Everyone knows girls and their periods sync up with the moon if they spend enough time outside.

Jazzy and Yoona can't decide on whether or not to be mad.

AKRAM

You're not going to make it if you phone it in and you're not going to make it if you don't ask for help. Or hold other people accountable. Do any of you want to be here?

They all nod.

AKRAM (CONT'D)

Why?

LARRY

I need to make a living. I thought life was all about following your dreams but my dreams have been suffocating me for quite some time. It's time to grow up, before I let them kill me.

AKRAM

Damn, okay. That was beautiful. Dude, are you a writer?

LARRY

Trying not to be. Anymore.

AKRAM

Okay. Well. You know best.

LARRY

Thanks.

Akram looks at Nirvaan.

NIRVAAN

I want to be a working actor but it could take me years to get there, like all the greats. So I need a waitressing job.

AKRAM

This is your waitressing job?

NIRVAAN

Yes. I can't have the life I need to have working at a restaurant. I need to be free to film auditions and go on leave if I book a role. And I can't have the life my parents **think** I have if I don't make at least enough money to pay for myself on our annual heli-skiing Christmas tour.

AKRAM

What?!

NIRVAAN

Oh, my parents think I'm a doctor. I have a degree in biology and computer science. I'm here to learn how to code. I know theory all day, but in my degree program we didn't really code. Plus, I need structure. I have ADHD.

JAZZY

Okay well, I can't keep building a 21-year old kid's social media empire whose the heir to Land O' Lakes butter. I feel soul-less. I want to build things. Like Elon Musk before he got hair plugs and a BBL.

(BEAT)

Did I just say aloud that I want a photo booth at my funeral?

Everyone is confused. Yoona presses on.

YOONA

My mom died and I need a good job to take care of my brothers. I don't want to just be a graphic designer. I want to make her proud. Also, I have to go home.

AKRAM

Oh my God, I forgot about the K-Pop triplets. Why would you leave them at home?

YOONA

Pfft. My mom left me at home when I was 4 and I cooked my own lunch.

NIRVAAN

And now they call that Montessori.

LARRY

!? No, they don't. Montessori is an actual methodology that allows kids to develop their own-

AKRAM

GO! NOW! Before CPS does!

Yoona dashes out as Larry and Nirvaan bicker. Jazzy rolls her eyes and sees Akram, having a lightbulb moment.

JAZZY

Oh no.

AKRAM

Pick a group name.

The group pieces things together. Larry thinks, Jazzy groans and Nirvaan-

NIRVAAN

Hell yeah!

Nirvaan tries to high five Jazzy.

JAZZY

Please God, no!

AKRAM

This is a gift. After today's presentations, I'm positive no one wants to work with any of you.

NIRVAAN

What's the next group project?

AKRAM

From now on, every group project is going to center around finding a business that will let you code a website for them. You guys have an opportunity to gain some experience and possibly make some money!

LARRY

How the hell are we going to find someone who wants to hire us to code a website for their business? Sexual favors?

(OFF JAZZY)

What? I'm a handsome guy.

AKRAM

Don't let him speak. At all. Ever.

Akram walks back inside as Jazzy rubs her temples.

INT. LARRY'S BASEMENT - A FEW DAYS LATER - DAY

Photos of Larry decorate the walls behind them in Larry's parent's finished basement.

Larry, Yoona, Nirvaan, and Jazzy huddle around an iPhone. Larry presses 'call'. A stern sounding man picks up.

STERN MAN

Hello?

JAZZY

Hi! Mr. Andrews. Thank you so much for making time to talk to us today.

STERN MAN

Yeah well, your boss says you do a good job doing the twitter and instagrams for him and now you're trying to do something with computers?

JAZZY

That is high praise coming from your son. I love my job there.

STERN MAN

So naturally I took this call. Mostly out of pity. But I am also just nosey.

Jazzy narrows her eyes.

JAZZY

Whaddya mean by that, Mr. Lawrence?

STERN MAN

I have to be honest, I normally hire a team of engineers from India. They work cheap and I can always get a hold of them.

YOONA

You're a horrible person. You are so lucky that Ja-

STERN MAN

What was that?

Nirvaan puts his hand over Yoona's mouth.

NIRVAAN

(WITH AN INDIAN ACCENT)

Hello Mr. Andrews!

STERN MAN

Hello?

JAZZY

Oh. Uhm. I was able to get the head of engineering on the call with us.

Larry's eyes widen.

NIRVAAN

Yes. I am here. My team of...

(COUNTING)

four senior engineers is looking forward to this project. It shouldn't take us more than a month to build an internal site for your employees. We were just hoping we could grab you or your assistant for some requirements.

They all look at Nirvaan in awe. He mutes the phone.

NIRVAAN (CONT'D)

Remember my name. One day you will see it in lights.

Nirvaan unmutes.

STERN MAN

Yes. I can definitely put you in touch with Land O'Lakes' martech team.

Jazzy exhales. The gang celebrates.

STERN MAN (CONT'D)

Jazmine, are you still there? I changed my mind. They say boomers can't do that.

JAZZY

I am still here. And thank you. We are so happy! We'll do it for free.

Larry and Yoona mouth no! Nirvaan covers both of their mouths.

NIRVAAN

Well, almost free.

JAZZY

\$100 a week until we get your internal site for employees up and running.

(MORE)

JAZZY (CONT'D)

Land O'Lakes will be our first client. And you can write it off on your taxes as...

STERN MAN

Diversity and Inclusion. My son told me already.

Jazzy is offended.

JAZZY

That's right.

NIRVAAN

Yes, so we have a deal?

STERN MAN

We do.

JAZZY

Okay. I'll follow up in an email and get in touch with Mark Tech.

NIRVAAN

Martech. Anyway, good bye and thank you.

Nirvaan hangs up. They are all quiet.

LARRY

Guys, I think we're off to something.

YOONA

Yeah, jail. You promised a month!

JAZZY

I'm sorry! I was counting \$100 for each of us.

LARRY

I think we can do it.

NIRVAAN

We can do anything.

Nirvaan puts his hands down to form a 90's team huddles. Jazzy places her hand on his. Yoona reluctantly puts her hand on Jazzy's.

LARRY

We can do anything... with ChatGPT.

JAZZY

Amen.